

Patricia Wallace

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Summary

Senior operations executive with over 20 years of experience leading multi-site manufacturing and distribution operations across Western Canada. Proven track record of driving operational excellence, leading large cross-functional teams, and delivering sustained margin improvement for consumer packaged goods and industrial manufacturing organizations.

Professional Experience

Vice President of Operations

Pacific Rim Manufacturing Corp., Vancouver, BC - Jan 2018 - Present

- Lead operations for 4 manufacturing facilities and 2 distribution centres across British Columbia and Alberta, overseeing a combined workforce of 620 employees and an annual operating budget of \$145M.
- Directed a multi-year operational excellence program that delivered \$18.2M in cumulative cost savings through lean manufacturing, automation, and procurement optimization.
- Restructured the regional supply chain network following a major acquisition, integrating 2 additional facilities within 9 months while maintaining 99.2% order fulfillment throughout the transition.
- Serve as executive sponsor for the company's ERP modernization initiative, overseeing a \$12M system implementation across finance, operations, and supply chain functions.
- Chair the executive Health and Safety Steering Committee, reducing the company's total recordable incident rate by 52% over five years and achieving a record-low lost-time injury rate in 2025.
- Report directly to the CEO and present quarterly operational performance and strategic initiatives to the Board of Directors.

Senior Director of Operations

Cascadia Industrial Products, Burnaby, BC - Apr 2013 - Dec 2017

- Led operations for 2 manufacturing plants and a regional distribution centre serving customers across Western Canada and the Pacific Northwest, managing a team of 340 employees.
- Championed the implementation of a company-wide continuous improvement program, training over 80 shop-floor supervisors in Kaizen methodology.
- Negotiated a renewed collective agreement with the production union, achieving a 5-year contract with no work stoppages.

- Reduced manufacturing scrap rates by 27% through root-cause analysis and targeted process redesign.

Director of Manufacturing

Cascadia Industrial Products, Burnaby, BC - Jun 2009 - Mar 2013

- Managed daily manufacturing operations for the company's largest production facility, with responsibility for 4 direct reports and 210 production staff.
- Led the capital project team for a \$22M plant expansion, delivering the project on time and 6% under budget.
- Improved overall equipment effectiveness (OEE) from 68% to 81% across the facility's primary production lines.

Plant Manager

Fraser Valley Packaging Ltd., Abbotsford, BC - Feb 2005 - May 2009

- Directed all aspects of plant operations, including production, quality, maintenance, and warehousing, for a 250,000 square foot packaging manufacturing facility.
- Achieved the plant's first-ever ISO 9001 certification, leading the cross-functional certification project team.
- Implemented a preventive maintenance program that reduced unplanned downtime by 34%.

Production Supervisor

Fraser Valley Packaging Ltd., Abbotsford, BC - Aug 2001 - Jan 2005

- Supervised 3 production shifts totaling 45 staff on a high-speed corrugated packaging line.
- Recognized with the company's Supervisor of the Year award in 2004 for leading the facility's top-performing shift.

Education

University of British Columbia, Sauder School of Business

Master of Business Administration | Vancouver, BC - 2010 - 2012

University of British Columbia

Bachelor of Applied Science, Industrial Engineering | Vancouver, BC - 1997 - 2001

Ivey Business School, Western University

Executive Certificate in Strategic Leadership | London, ON - 2016

Certifications

Certified Six Sigma Black Belt - ASQ, 2014

Gold Seal Certified Project Manager - CCA, 2011

Skills

Multi-site operations leadership, P&L management, Lean manufacturing / Kaizen, Labour relations & collective bargaining, Capital project management, ERP implementation, Supply chain integration,

Health and safety leadership, Board reporting and governance, Mergers and acquisitions integration

Board & Leadership Activities

Board Director

BC Manufacturing Association - 2021 - Present

- Serve on the board of a 400-member provincial manufacturing industry association, chairing the workforce development committee.

Advisory Board Member

BCIT School of Business Manufacturing Program - 2019 - Present

- Advise on curriculum development to align academic training with current industry operations needs.

Past President

Vancouver Chapter, Association for Supply Chain Management (ASCM) - 2015 - 2019

- Led a 150-member professional chapter, organizing monthly education events and an annual regional conference.

Volunteer Executive Mentor

Women in Manufacturing Canada - 2017 - Present

- Mentor senior women pursuing executive operations roles in manufacturing across Western Canada.